



Contributions to
Science and Arts
Philosophy and Religion.
(First Original)

Hung Yut Sang

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The Obsequies of the Gods

An approach to humanistic religion

"In the name of God, I can do everything? In the name of man, I can do nothing?"

Modern man is a forlorn clown amidst his spurious mosaic of existence: his action is powerless, his mind dissociates from reality, his life is paved with abysmal loneliness, his agonized countenance ghastly delineates his apathy and impotence in relation to the objective world. To seek any consistent image of him will surely be futile and discouraging - his portrait is but a nihilistic one. The plurality of conflicting modern ideologies has compelled man to forsake his well-scrubbed cradle of traditional, authoritarian religions, leaving him in a precarious state of indecisive anxiety. Ethical relativism has parched his touchstone of reality to another Hiroshima. Gone are the Gods and the myths man clings to. Gone are the *ius divinum* and dogma man entertains. Grasped in the infinite, ever-expanding spiral of metamorphoses, he traipses like a lost child inside his labyrinthine superstructure. Only darkness and despair prevail; not even a trace of searing light can be found. But to weep or linger in such appalling night is of no avail - for it can only throttle his² hopes slowly, aggravate his fright and anxiety and nothing else. After all, is it better still, and prouder indeed, to be a bold explorer than a mere marionette of the times? Really, modern man is adrift on the raft of the Medusa in the seething ocean of meaninglessness; he is just a

rover craving for a spiritual home but is denied it. The grasp of the complexity of his social institutions and his objective reality renders him powerless, creating crimes, social evils and a general disgust of life. This is a society of voluptuary, draped with braided robes and good food. This is also a world of misery, beset by wars, crimes and pollutions. Thus, to man, any objective, alien value system is but a delusion; any frantic, zealous belief is but a myth. And delusion does not exist; myth dies as well. Instead of the brass on the Communist Manifesto, the sign of modern man is absurdity and absurdity is the very being of his world, the very stuff of his reality. Perhaps nothing can be more distressing and preposterous for him - a wanderer who realizes that the only truth in the world is that he shall never find what he is for. Consequently, his actions become powerless, frozen. His existence becomes isolated - there is nothing left for man except an incongruous suffocating spiritual vacuum. All he can do is to jump into the fathomless vortex of mass culture, carried away by its ordeal and homogenized by its appeal. Only numbness and anxiety dominate his life. Only Thanatos triumphs and rejoices in its relentless grin.

Such, in essence, and even more absurd, more void of meaning, is the world of modern science and philosophy. And such a preposterous and wanton world of nothingness, in no time

rover craving for a spiritual home but is denied it. The growth of the complexity of his social institutions and his objective reality renders him powerless, creating crimes, social evils and a general disgust of life. This is a society of voluptuary, draped with brandy ditches and good food. This is also a world of misery, bemused by wars, crimes and pollutions. Thus, to man, any objective, absolute value system is but a delusion; any frantic, zealous belief is but a myth. And delusion does not exist; myth dies as well. Instead of the brood of the Communist Manifesto, the sign of modern man is absurdity and absurdity is the very being of his world, the very stuff of his reality. Perhaps nothing can be more distressing and preposterous for him - a wanderer who realizes that the only truth in the world is that he shall never find what he seeks for. Consequently, his actions become powerless, frozen. His existence becomes isolated - there is nothing left for man except an incongruous suffocating spiritual vacuum. All he can do is to jump into the fathomless vortex of mass culture, carried away by its ordeal and homogenized by its appeal. Only numbness and anxiety dominate his life. Only Thanatos triumphs and rejoices in its relentless grin.

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at all, man must henceforth build a shrine for his ideals and create a humanistic religion for himself. Suppose that man is but a fortuitous conglomeration of atoms, a lonesome child of probability in the course of evolution with no prevision of what he is and what he shall be. Or that he is a son of the star-dusts without cause or just claim of any kind; that the zenith of man's strivings, his arts, his sciences, his ideals, his music will inevitably be buried in the debris of the expanding universe; and that his consciousness, his soul, his loves and hopes, his gods and his beliefs will never survive after his brief years of life. Or suppose that time is irreversible and that the whole universe is running down with increasing entropy, by which no devout prayers, no heroism, no passionate longings, no lofty aspirations can reverse or even hope to preserve; and that any value system is arbitrary and that truth is merely the caprice of the gods, determined solely by the vogue of the ages. Or even that all the splendour of human achievements, all the loftiest emotions, all the aspects of humanity, are destined to vanish in the dusk and infinitum. Yet, these generalizations and prognostications, if not absolutely certain, are not far from the truth - that any religion or philosophy whatsoever, in their ephemeral course of existence, should endorse, or else be fallen.

The Fall of man - the obsequies of the gods

Man is not man before Adam and Eve - he was enthralled to his physical universe, under the mercy of the inexorable powers of Nature. For epochs, he was a creature of instinctual patterns, conditioned by his natural environment. He fed, walked, killed and reproduced without cause, and without asking a cause. He was just an unthinking animal, manipulated by the gods. Yet, however improbable, a miracle occurred - the omnipotent but blind Nature in her secular epopee through the abysses of space, had at last brought forth a child called man, still under her dominion, but gifted with self-awareness, with knowledge of good and evil, and with an objective system of studying the handiwork of his alien and inhuman Mother. Thus, the first fall of man began - he ceased to be the mere puppets of his Lords. Despite the fact that he was tempted to lead a settled life, to practise a powerful discipline called science and to transcend his natural universe, he was still, at times, tyrannized by his physical reality. Fearful and timid as he was, and as he is, he seeks compassions from the gods - which are but the higher phase of his consciousness. Moreover, knowing that he can't ever taste the forbidden fruit of immortality, he invents systems of theology to fulfil his vain reverie, so that after his irrevocable death, he can't still inherit eternal life - to be as his gods. Haunted in his ultimate concern,

the savage man can do nothing but impose his own beliefs on others, as a system of ultimate, indubitable truth. Disobedience and infidelity¹⁰ are regarded as the gravest sins and are supposed to deserve everlasting damnation. Thus, in the name of his Gods, the savage man can do everything. Such also is the attitude of those, who, in our age, base their belief upon any kind of dogmatic ideologies and the like.

The birth pangs of modern agnosticism and humanism have temporarily caused man to lose his self-identity and his consciousness. But all these perverse and warped phenomena, as called by the pious, are but the mere inception of their long-repressed nightmare - the upheaval of iconoclastic Evolutionism and Freudism has already shattered their artistic reveries of anthropocentrism and piety; Victorian Puritanism has undergone a bizarre dialectical reversal and re-emerges as ~~Demagonian~~ ^{Dionysian} orgies; radical atheism blooms brilliantly from the bud of devout religiosity by which the Gods are guillotined. Thus springs the second fall of man - the degeneration of man from an instinctual, helpless and emotionally morbid creature to an autonomous, independent and thinking being, has paid homage to the obsequies of the Gods. Man is no creature any more. He is the creator, the creator of his own Fate, his own being and destiny. Man no longer conforms to the immutable necessity of determinism¹² - once again, he is bestowed the Edenic apple of freedom. Nevertheless, his acquired

free will forces him to renunciate his ultimate source of security - his refuge in authoritarian religions. There is nothing, absolutely nothing in this world to guide him; he has to face his world alone; he has to cope with his nostalgia and loneliness inherent in his extraterrestrial life. In his godless world everything is possible. In his chaotic universe, every entity is a reductio ad absurdum.

The death of the gods - the birth of humanity.

The answer to our age is not blowing in the wind; nor does it lie in any sacred doctrinaire books with inviolable, deterministic truth. The answer to our age lies in ourselves. By actively transcending ourselves, we can erect a humanistic religion, a shrine where man can ennoble his little days. It is time for man to wear from the lethal ambrosia of dogmatism. It is time for man to liberate himself from the tyranny of the gods. It is time for man to murder his gods in his hearts. To defy the gods with fierce hatred to will the death of the gods, seem necessary and inevitable to the assertion of freedom. The free man can do nothing but admit that the gods are but his devils for he, by his very own nature, is a sempiternal rover, an agnostic wanderer with humanity at heart and indeterminism in mind.

What move me as a human being, an individual of the species *Homo sapiens*, are not the facets and tragedies of my experience, but the similitude of my experience with others. Upon this cornerstone of empathy, upon this concrete humanity, we can penetrate and consolidate with the emotional being of our fellow men; we can transform the vision of our mundane world into a celestial paradise. No longer do we demand that we are infallible and perfect. However, we can accept and transcend our flaw and blemish with the courage to be, without losing our starry hopes and lofty aspirations. We sometimes are enshrouded by despair and woe, agonized by the omnipotent Fate. Many times have we faltered. Many times have we been thwarted and languished by our loss and defeat, under the bondage of Self. Many times have we been veiled by our improvident outlook. Brooded by our morbid thoughts, our hopes become diminished. Our senses become inebriated. Our world seems to be sombre and desperate. Yet, as our insight into life grows, we realize that life itself is too transient to be obsessed by personal joy or grief. We realize that we have to give; we have to inquire into the external world and transcend it; we have to discern people, to feel with them without any intellectual pride; we have to develop a never-tiring joy of learning and giving. Let us recall that our fellow-men are but ourselves. Brief their lives are, their bliss or misery depend on us. In this absurd world of being, where are

are condemned to ¹⁷ love our dearest, where death triumphs in its universal roar, there is nothing left except to cherish and to give. Reality, to us, is always novel and capricious; yet we can always achieve ontological security through the tenderness of human love, the humility of independence and the merging of our sciences and humanities. Acceptance, tolerance and transcendence are our virtues. Mystical love can transform our selves completely the exaltation of our beloved, allied with the acceptance and transcendence of the defects of humanity, can cause an existential reincarnation in our selves. The experience of other selves is always new, refreshing ¹⁸ and is worth exploration, love and exaltation. This gives us not only a unity with our fellow men, but also a cosmic consciousness and an existential rebirth which are but our ultimate concern, which we and the Universe exist in the highest consummation. We immediately feel that we, the human race are but One. The free man recognizes no dogma but the dogma of affection. He senses no obstacle but the obstacle of ligatures. In order to perceive our complex, intricate world and to change it, it is necessary for us to shake off ¹⁹ our intellectual and moral pride, to feel with the mass, yet to stand aloof analytically; to share others' experience, joy and sadness, yet to be aware of the objective conditions.

Be it ours to shed light upon them, to be empathic with their life. In a universe where entropy always increases, where universal death is inevitable, we can do nothing but to accept it. Through our endeavors, I believe that we can be tragically beautiful and make our fleeting existence unique, as well as eternal. Let us blaze with the fervent zest of life. We falter but we strive to stand. We suffer rejection but continue to ^{so} give. Let us not judge people by our grudging scale of merits or demerits, but rather let us think in their own terms and extend our precious quality of empathy. In this way, we can become deeply religious, thus giving us a feeling of pantheistic ecstasy and undivided religiosity. In this way, and perhaps no other, we can be the true children of the Universe.

6th August, 1978

The psychology of ultimate concern and the mass psychosis of religion
The psychotic, the pious and their world.

The psychotic

Perhaps the most desperate, the most solitary fighter in the world is the psychotic, who dwells only in his undifferentiated, inauthentic reality. And nothing more: he is merely the specter of the times, the non-being amid his human counterparts. This is a miniature world of fantasy, haunted by dreams and hallucinations, realized only by the normal people in their sleeping life - no matter it is a rose garden or a cuckoo's nest. Tyrannized by his Unconscious, he seeks to act out his fantasy as if it were true. To regain sanity will be a horrible, if not impossible, dream - for he has to admit defeat and to tackle with his emotional imbroglio or impasse once more. Nothing can be more disgusting and anguish-provoking than his psychological impasse. Thus, he himself erects a fata morgana - a castle in the air and abides in it, maintaining that this castle is real and authentic. Withdrawal from the external world occurs and the psychotic merely resides in his inner fake reality. For some time, he is an active creator - creating his imaginary, fantastic universe through² his own artistic processes. He acts so as not to be understood. He feels and behaves as if he were another person.

The pious

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To any devout believer of authoritarian religions, the world, at large, is somewhat an illusion, or at least, there exists another eternal, all-good heaven which is tremendously better than this secular and evil world. He, like the psychotic, is also an active creator - creating an inner, false reality of the gods, in which a range of religious feelings pervades - from complete masochistic submission to the gods to mystical communion with them. He acts as if the gods took possession of his self. In fact, he can only be himself under the complete dominion and order of the gods. Autonomy and independence, for him, are mere dreams. All he can do is to cling to his gods with absolute dependency - he acts only according to the will of the gods. He is just a machine, a puppet of the gods.

The psychiatry of ultimate concern and the mass psychosis of piety

The evolution and development of religions are, in fact, a partial reflection of the psychological needs of man, where the sundry spectrum of religious feelings - complete masochistic submission, absolute dependency, mystical ecstatic communion or else finds their realization in the gods. The appeal of them lies in the fact that these varieties of psychological needs as security, love and ecstasy can be satisfied both simultaneously and almost unceasingly. We usually find that the mad, "and" those with extreme

piety, have a great deal of unfortunate and unhappy experience. Their development of their self-systems is largely impaired by pathological interpersonal interactions, mostly at a parental or familial level. They are fixated at their early developmental stages and seek to escape such situations through the establishment of a false-self system. Thus, the objective reality is distorted or denied through delusion and paranoid behaviour, yielding an wide varieties of psychopathological symptoms ranging from our chronic psychotics requiring life-long hospitalization to our mild religious psychotics who preach and pray. One sad fact is that this false-self system is usually isolated and closed to any environmental stimuli to the extent that the martyrs always die gloriously and fearlessly.

Many human instinctual impulses can be channelled in religions, with a system of rituals and cults. Thus, mystical union with the gods takes the place of physical spiritual union with our beloved; and paratherapeutic ecstasy replaces mystico-sexual reincarnation. It is interesting to see that many authoritarian or dogmatic religions show both gross and subtle characteristics of human sexuality while debasing or even repressing the full expressions of them. In fact, sexual inhibitions, as practised in nearly all forms of authoritarian religions or dogmatic ideologies, serve to prevent rational thinking and feeling in human

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beings, particularly in adolescents, who reach the developmental stage of identity diffusion. They are extremely susceptible to the vehement, deep 'conversions' to any of these dogmatic ideologies, which give them feelings of personal worth and idealistic cravings. It is not uncommon that the converts show a complete different way of life and attitudes and are filled with lofty aspirations or high hopes, believing that they are both dedicated to a divine cause. Thus, many of them become highly ascetic and puritanical, extremely devoted to their beliefs - they are all caught in the vicious circle of ultimate concern. There is a positive identification of this substitute of mystico-sexual reincarnation with the all-refreshing, mystical experience of first love. The exaltation of men believed as gods or goddesses, the joys, the ecstasy and the thrills as experienced are somewhat similar to such conversions, or rebirth, as it is called. Yet, these forms of religious ecstasy do not produce a mystico-sexual reincarnation or even orgasmic gratification. Instinctual impulses of sex dam up and reinforce themselves as an intense orgasmic cravings, which are usually accompanied by psychosomatic symptoms. Besides, pleasure anxiety and unconscious guilt-feelings become associated with sexual practices, thus giving way to masochistic surrender and mystical religious feelings. Consequently, the suppression of human sexuality is one of the determinants in the appeal of dogmatic ideologies or religions. From a behavioural standpoint, many practices in religions are

stimulus-response associations learned to avoid conflict or anxiety. Faulty reinforcement and conditioning make the pious, as well as the psychotic, brood over autistic preoccupations, thus producing irrelevant responses. The objective environment, for them, is ingenuine - it simply fail to reinforce certain sequences of behaviour. Prayers, hymns, reading of sacred books and worship of sacred places, persons or imaginary figures all reflect such abnormal conditioning. The religious activities carried out often include an element of compulsiveness; or else intense anxiety will be aroused.

The experiential and emotional structures of the pious, like the psychotics, are but shattered debris, or at most castles building in the air. They erect their personality structures on nothingness - there is nothing left in the world for them, except some vague concepts such as the gods, the devils or so. The acquired complexes of guilt and anxiety make them relinquish mystico-sexual reincarnation and direct their instinctual impulse of physico-spiritual union to an unhealthy, morbid spectrum of masochistic religious feelings from masochistic submission to mystical communion with the gods. Devoid of any organic experience, they seek release and gratification through prayers, hymns and transcendental union with the gods. By becoming helpless and submissive, they can regress to their earlier

stage of vicissitudes to supernatural an incredible towards death end of the dialectically the inquis reinforcement compulsively interactions unrealistic opinions¹² an dimension.

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stage of psychological development and be sheltered from the vicissitudes of life. As a result, they are increasingly drawn to supernatural support and be absolutely dependent on them, developing an incredible intensity of conviction, even a passive indifference towards death, for they expect to be rewarded eternally after the end of the world. Sometimes, these substitutions for lust change dialectically to sadistic-aggressiveness which was common to the inquisitors of the Middle Ages. Moreover, conditioning and reinforcement forces them to perform many religious rites compulsively, thus intensifying their beliefs. The interpersonal interactions employed by them are pathological: they usually have unrealistic percepts as well as judgements. Their selves are spurious ¹² and indistinct as if they came from another dimension.

The transition to psychosis - the conversion

To traverse from normality to psychosis is nearly a discontinuous quantum jump. The individual concerned is somehow aware of his wretched condition and actively seeks help from reality, especially interpersonal warmth and security. But when any help, or even hope, does not turn up, he will choose his internal resources, if any, for relief. As a matter of fact, his mode of interaction with the reality

gradually changes from syntactic to parataxic or even protaxic. He simply distorts the reality in order to escape from conflict and anxiety. He actively creates his imposed, assimilating personal constructs of his world and wills his self to live in accordance with them. Eventually, when his emotional will vanquishes his rationality, the individual wills his self to dwell in his false reality, forming a false self system with undifferentiated values and actions. There is almost no force to hold him back. The process of conversion is somewhat similar, except that the transition is much more subtle and takes place unconsciously. Conversion involves a commitment to an ^{inauthentic} system of reality, so does psychosis. Although both ^{the psychotic and the psychotic} ^{system} interact with their illusions, they are both convinced that they discover the truth.

The case of Jesus

There are many queer events in history and some of them are queerer than we can imagine. Many great religions and many mass movements in the world were founded by chronic psychotics. A variety of them still persists in our own day and will probably continue to appeal to the irrationality of the mass and the intellectuals.

The standing of Jesus in the Christian religion is

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momentous - he is regarded as the founder of it as well as
the Son of God, who came to Earth to fulfil the divine
plan of salvation. However, in psychiatric diagnosis, Jesus was
demonstrably mad if he was not the Son of God. In fact,
he may be classified as a paranoid, or even with a syndrome
of various psychotic reactions. The life of Jesus was characterized
both by the presence of persecutory and grandiose delusions.
He claimed to be the Son of God many times - he was
deeply convinced of his divine nature and his possession of esoteric
knowledge of mankind. Events in the world and the actions of
people were interpreted in terms of Christ's emotional reactions -
rather than through any process of logical thinking. Besides, from
his baptism to his crucifixion, he showed an elaborate,
intricate delusional system of persecution and grandeur. From a
psychoanalytical standpoint, his symptoms sprang from unfulfilled
desires as related to fixation in a psychological developmental
stage. It is not surprising that why Jesus attracted, and attracts
many people, particularly adolescents - his life and emotion are but
mirrors of the force and myths in our own unconscious; they
all represent some of the weaknesses in humanity, which we,
as well as Jesus share. Human beings, in essence, are
highly vulnerable, both physically and mentally, to ^{unhealthy} environmental and
interpersonal interactions. When we are reared up in such pathological

environment, we cannot help but become sick. I suppose that Jesus was the same - he was just a human psychotic with a sad life and many unfortunate experiences. I shall attempt to explore this interesting theme in another essay, 'the personality structure of Jesus Christ' in due course.

Therapy

Just as the process of becoming a psychotic or a devout believer, the course of therapy involves will. The patient is made to perceive his external reality and should will to abandon his false-self structure. Boyled with interpersonal support and intimacy, the patient is then forced to leave the associated religious rites through impulsive therapy or systematic desensitization. Perhaps it may be futile, and even improbable, to change the false-self system and its distorted or denied reality of the pious, but it is always worthwhile to try - to have them confronted with the human world again, instead of letting them escape from their freedom and responsibility.

10th August, 1978.

The Methodology of Science - an introduction into science and Reality

Definition

Science is a human disciplinary inquiry in which higher-order abstracts or constructs of reality is incorporated into a formal mathematical structure as theoretical models or hypothetico-deductive systems through the processes of empirical experimentations, analytical description, systematic classifications, positive generalizations and synthetic conceptualizations. Thus, facts and phenomena in the natural or human world are quantized through sense-data as mathematical entities from which logico-mathematical relations are explored. Postulates or hypotheses are proposed to explain these relations. Theorems, corollaries and other properties are inferred from the totality of such hypotheses and these predictions are checked directly or indirectly through experimentation. Extraneous or inconsistent hypotheses are thus eliminated. When no contradiction occurs to the known facts, these systems of hypotheses gain the status of theories.

Epistemology of Science

The ontological assumptions of science are built up from critical realism, which is probably an outgrowth of logico-empiricism and rationalism. The central theses of critical realism* are as follows:

1. There exist entities or objects independent of mind.
2. They are knowable through partial or successive approximations.
3. Any knowledge of a thing in itself is attained by experience and reason.

* From 'Mario Bunge'.

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4. Factual knowledge is hypothetical rather than apodictic. It is corrigible and not final.

5. Scientific knowledge is roundabout and symbolic.

10th August, 1978

It is corrigible

10th August, 1978

The Home of the Harpies

An inquiry into pathological familial interactions
The family and the individual

The family is a social institution in which the fundamental human processes are performed. It is an intimate, interpersonal organization originating from the pair-bond formation and the fulfilment of sexual urges in human beings. The family also plays an important role in the transmission of culture, through which norms, values and ethical ideals are internalized in the descending generation by familial interactions. While it is true that many social processes and phenomena (such as social stratification) can be brought into a parental-familial matrix, we can almost conclude that functional mental disorder is largely the consequence of pathological interactions between the members of the family. Indeed, the affect field of the family is so profound that many future actions, experience, attitudes and behaviour of a person are determined by its influence - it nearly fixes the 'fate' of the person involved; he will remain in this rose, otherwise weed garden until his death unless he is aware of its existence and actively transcending it.

Since the family is one of the most intimate human groups, interactional processes between its members are largely unconscious and genuine, revealing the true selves of them. Faulty conditioning and reinforcement are thus exposed. Moreover, the degree of intimacy

is likely to arouse tension and anxiety in such relationships. In this essay, I shall start by noting several cases of mild mental disorders encountered in real life and develop my theme concurrently.

The case of Mr. X

Mr. X is an old friend of mine. He is twenty-one years of age, bony but quite masculine. For years, he has sustained an inadequate and perhaps pathological relationship with girls. In fact, he cannot develop durable friendship with girls. Once or twice, he admits that he³ cannot believe in such friendship and holds that no such friendship ever exists. When he develops, or rather, induces a considerable emotional attachment of a girl to him, he will deliberately hurt her by neglect, verbal sarcasm and insults. He behaves as if he were very casual in his studies, achievements and excellence, but he is at all very serious and demanding. Being secretive and concealing in his personal affairs, his feelings and his self, he will not expose his weaknesses to others. He lies frequently to his friends, lest they would betray him and hurt him. His familial interactions⁴ are poor and meagre - he is always hiding something from his family and he becomes

a Catholic and is converted to understand his information of -

The case of Mr. Y, student. I have the clearest

in such relationships.
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a Catholic (and wants to be a Father as well) when his family
is converted to Protestantism. Unfortunately, I cannot go on to
understand his situation for he is too refractory to divulge
information of himself.

The case of Mr. Y.

He is twenty-one
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Mr. Y, aged twenty, is a successful outstanding college
student. I have known him for many years and probably have
the clearest understanding and account of him.

Nothing can move her in her way,
not even the little-sweet passion,
or the staid gaudy day.

A woman born of the ~~best~~ loftiest ~~style~~ ^{attitude}, inclination
of indifference and style.

But she is like a fragile reed.

So proves to herself,

the Extremities,

to take and make the risks life ^{is} ~~gives~~.

Admit only the simple or the less,
or the more.

Or just pretend to accept,
these hard facts of her life.

Constantly checking herself,
and save all delusions in her chest.

Say they are true - and what's the difference?

To live without living,

To love without being in love.

and weaves her guide in a cobweb.

Half-hysterical, half-possessed,

contriving ~~everything~~ without knowledge,

or without any restraint at all.

She plays dice with her life,

and escapes from herself,
seems to her an indulgent phase.

A deep and sensitive soul within,
yielding to no counterpart,
all at a loss.

Without reason or hope,
in a timeless mind.

Where hatred and guilt turned to simpler passions.
diffuse and foreign as ghost.

But she's the real culprit of her soul,
tormenting herself with that *la belle* indifference,
with that great tragic sense, deceiving and deceived
still thinks that she's not ~~misleading~~ in any way,
~~is~~ choosing a way to her contrary,
in a naughtier and haughtier style,
still maintaining her consistency,

denying but not forgetting,
for all she ~~has~~ done and felt.

and ~~thinks~~ ^{feels} she is serious herself
making all kinds of justifications
or rationalizations as such,

have herself believe in those.

So entrenched with her contrived circumstances,

deeply convinced of her own nature,
she makes them out of her own choice
and bears upon them her own.

A perplexing creature as she is,
acting out of instant feelings.

All her life an illusion ^{of who she is}
Of who she is, but where is she?

She's no timid; nor simple
so harsh in her determination,
not even promise herself.

She's but a dream within,
but cannot stand others dreaming,
or loving as innocent men do,

for these are just dreams of her dream.
Someday she may wake up,
with all her past life a dream,

with that familiar emptiness and solitude.

A feeling of not living before or after.
and doubts of the dreams of her dream.

^{How can she ever}
~~She~~ can ~~never~~ face

her own reality, and move beyond ^{of} who she has been.
or live in this knitted world
as though she is absent.

1. The Obsequies of the Gods - an approach to humanistic religion.

'In the name of God, I can do everything? In the name of man, I can do nothing?'

i) The Fall of man - the obsequies of the gods

ii) The death of the gods - the birth of humanity.

2. The psychology of ultimate concern and the mass psychosis of religion - the psychotic, the pious and their world.

i) The psychotic

ii) The pious

iii) The psychiatry of ultimate concern and the mass psychosis of piety.

iv) The transition to psychosis - the conversion

v) The case of Jesus

vi) Therapy

3. The methodology of science - an introduction to Science and Reality

i) Definition

ii) Epistemology of science

4. The Home of the Hayris - an inquiry into pathological familial interactions.

i) The family and the individual

ii) The case of Mr. X